AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
Faculty of Business Studies

B329

Leadership in changing world

MTA Questions Paper / Version C

2025-2026 / Fall
4-December-2025

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Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 Hours**

Instructions:

1- Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED OFF" mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4- You **MUST** answer the questions using only the answer booklets provided
5- You **MUST** return the examination paper together with your answer booklets.
6- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
7- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during th examination
8- Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
9- Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

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Case Study

Fadi Ghandour – Building Aramex with a Multicultural Vision

Fadi Ghandour, a Jordanian entrepreneur, is the founder of **Aramex**, the first Arab company to be listed on the NASDAQ. Aramex started in 1982 as a regional courier company and has grown into a **global logistics and transportation provider**, operating across the Middle East, Africa, Asia, and Europe.

Ghandour's leadership success came not only from business strategy, but from **deep cultural awareness** and his ability to navigate and integrate diverse values across continents.

Understanding His Own Culture

Coming from an Arab background, Ghandour emphasized:

Relationship-based business practices

Trust, loyalty, and respect in leadership

A community-driven, collectivist mindset

He recognized that in Arab culture, personal credibility and long-term relationships are essential to business success. His leadership style reflected these values, building loyalty among teams and partners.

Recognizing Cultural Differences

As Aramex expanded globally, Ghandour had to:

Work with partners and clients from Western, African, and Asian cultures

Adapt to different leadership expectations, decision-making speeds, and communication styles

Manage a diverse workforce made up of Arabs, Africans, Asians, and Western expatriates

He realized that imposing Arab-style leadership in all regions would fail. Instead, he built a culture that was globally adaptive yet locally sensitive.

Multicultural Leadership in Action

Decentralized Management: Ghandour gave regional teams autonomy, allowing them to lead based on local norms and customer behaviors.

Empowerment and Inclusion: He encouraged innovation from all levels and cultures—challenging traditional Arab hierarchical systems.

Cultural Integration: Rather than exporting a corporate culture, Aramex absorbed local perspectives, ensuring its brand and service remained relevant in every market.

He also supported cross-cultural training and development, helping teams appreciate differences instead of fearing them.

Aramex became a regional success story and a model for startups in the Arab world.

The company's flexible and culturally intelligent model allowed it to compete with global giants like FedEx and DHL in emerging markets.

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Ghandour became a respected thought leader in entrepreneurship and social impact across the MEA region.

QUESTION NO 1 (30 Marks)

If you were expanding a company like Aramex into a new African or Asian market, what leadership strategies from Ghandour's example would you apply? Why?

QUESTION NO 2 (30 Marks)

How did Ghandour's cultural awareness contribute to Aramex's success in competing with global logistics companies?

QUESTION NO 3 (40 MARKS)

Adaptive leadership is a leadership approach developed by Ronald Heifetz and Marty Linsky that focuses on helping people in organizations or communities navigate complex challenges that don't have clear-cut solutions.

Critically discuss how adoptive leaders can lead organization to change.

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END OF QUESTIONS

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